



NestBook

Your Complete Getting Started Guide

Everything you need to go from "just verified" to taking your first direct booking — one calm step at a time.

Welcome to NestBook

You've just verified your email, and that's genuinely the hardest part done — from here it's just a series of small, sensible steps.

This guide is written for one purpose: so you never have to guess what to do next, and never have to switch between the app and a help page to figure something out. Everything is here, in the order you'll actually need it.

You don't need to be technical to use NestBook, and you don't need to read this guide from cover to cover in one sitting. Work through it at whatever pace suits you — do a step, close the guide, come back to it tomorrow. Nothing here is timed or urgent except the small handful of things we've clearly marked.

How this guide is organised

Each step below matches something you'll actually do inside NestBook, roughly in the order most owners tackle them. If your property is a whole-property rental (a gîte, cottage, or lodge that's booked as one unit) rather than individual rooms, a few sections won't apply to you — we've noted those clearly as we go.

A quick note on plans

Some features are only available on certain plans. Where that's the case, you'll see a small coloured tag like this: **PRO** or **MULTI**. If you don't see a tag, the feature is available on every plan, including Free.

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A one-page summary you can print and tick off

1 You're verified — what happens next

A calm walk-through of your very first login, so nothing on the screen feels unfamiliar.

Once you click the verification link from your welcome email, you'll be taken straight into NestBook and logged in automatically. There's nothing further to do to "activate" your account — verifying your email *is* the activation.

What you'll see first

You'll land on your **Dashboard** — the home screen of NestBook. On a brand new account, it will look fairly empty, and that's completely normal. Right now it's simply waiting for you to add your property details, your rooms, and your first booking. By the end of this guide, this same screen will be showing you real, useful information every time you log in.

Along the left-hand side (or, on a phone, tucked behind the menu icon) you'll see your main navigation:

Menu item	What it's for
Dashboard	Your daily overview — today's arrivals, departures, and anything needing your attention
Calendar	A visual week-by-week view of every room and every booking
Bookings	A searchable list of every booking, past and future
Guests	Your guest records — names, contact details, stay history
Rooms	Where you set up and manage each room (or your whole property)
Pricing	Seasonal rates and special pricing periods
Billing	Your subscription, invoices, and Stripe Connect for card payments
Settings	Everything about how your property and account are configured
Reports PRO	Revenue reports, expenses, and financial summaries

There is no wrong order

We're about to walk through setup in the order most owners find easiest, but nothing will break if you jump ahead or come back to something later. Every setting can be changed at any time.

One decision to make early: rooms, or whole property?

Before you go much further, it's worth being clear on which type of property you have, because it changes what a few screens look like:

- **Individual rooms** — you have several rooms or units, each bookable separately (a B&B, a small guest house, a hotel-style property). Guests choose a specific room.
- **Whole property** — your entire property is booked as one unit by one party at a time (a gîte, a holiday cottage, a lodge, a villa). There's nothing to "choose" — it's simply available or it isn't.

You'll set this when you fill in your Property Details in the next step, and NestBook will quietly adjust several screens to match — for example, whole-property owners won't see room-by-room occupancy stats that wouldn't make sense for them, and won't see a breakfast toggle, since whole-property guests typically self-cater.

2 Your property details

The foundation everything else builds on — go to [Settings → Property Details](#)

This is usually the very first thing to fill in, because a handful of other screens (your booking page, your widget, your emails to guests) all pull information from here.

Property name

This is what your guests will see everywhere — on your booking page, in confirmation emails, and on your widget. It's worth taking a moment to get this exactly right, since it also shapes your booking page web address (more on that in Step 7).

Property type

This is where you confirm rooms vs. whole-property, as covered in Step 1.

Address

Your full street address. This is used to show a map on your standalone booking page, so guests can see exactly where you are before they book.

Check-in and check-out times

Set the times you actually want guests arriving and leaving. This isn't just informational — NestBook uses it to sensibly guide the app itself. For example, the "Check In" button on your Dashboard won't let a booking be marked as checked in before your configured check-in time has actually arrived, which stops accidental early check-ins being logged by mistake.

Why the check-in time matters more than it looks

If you ever go to check a guest in and the button doesn't seem to work, it's very likely simply because it's before your set check-in time. This is working as intended, not a fault — NestBook will tell you the exact time check-in opens if you try early.

Currency

Set this once, correctly, at the start — it affects every rate, every invoice, and every guest-facing price across the whole system.

Description

A free-text description of your property, shown on your standalone booking page. Write it the way you'd describe your property to a friend — warm and honest tends to work far better than a list of amenities alone.

Properties

If you're on the Multi plan and manage more than one property, this is also where you add and switch between them. Each property has entirely separate rooms, bookings, guests, and settings.

Appearance

NestBook comes with seven complete colour themes — Forest, Navy, Warm Gold, Ruby, Sky Blue, Lavender, and Charcoal. Pick whichever one feels most like your property; your booking widget and standalone booking page will automatically match whatever you choose here. You're welcome to change this at any time — nothing is locked in.

3 Adding your rooms (or your whole property)

Go to Rooms in the main menu

If you're set up as individual rooms, this is where you'll add each one. If you're a whole-property rental, you'll add a single entry representing the entire property — everything below still applies, just with one listing instead of several.

Basic details

Give each room a clear name (guests will see this — "Room 3" is functional but "The Garden Room" tends to book better), set its maximum capacity, and add a description. As with your property description, a genuine, specific description of the room usually reassures a guest far more than a generic one.

Base rate

This is the room's standard nightly price — the price that applies unless a seasonal rate (Step 4) says otherwise. You can always come back and adjust this.

Photos

Upload as many photos as your plan allows — Free properties can upload 1 photo per room, Pro allows 5, and Multi allows 10. Your first photo becomes the "hero" photo shown on your booking page and in the room card on your widget. You can click any thumbnail afterwards to switch which one guests see first.

Photos genuinely matter

Guests decide whether to click through to book largely based on your photos, before they've read a single word of your description. It's worth taking a little extra time here — natural light, a tidy room, and a photo that shows the whole space (not just a close-up) all help.

Amenities

Tick whichever amenities genuinely apply — Wi-Fi, en-suite, air conditioning, and so on. These show on your booking page and help a guest quickly judge whether the room suits them.

Breakfast (rooms mode only)

If breakfast is available for this specific room, you can flag it here — we cover the full breakfast setup in Step 5.

If you're on Multi and manage several properties

Make sure you're working inside the correct property before adding rooms — the property switcher is in Settings, and every room belongs to exactly one property.

4 Setting your rates and seasonal pricing

Go to [Pricing](#), or [Settings → Seasonal Pricing](#)

Every room already has a base rate from Step 3 — that's the rate that applies by default, every night, unless you tell NestBook otherwise. Seasonal Pricing is how you tell it otherwise, for the periods where your prices genuinely change: a summer peak, a quiet winter rate, a premium week over Christmas and New Year.

Creating a rate period

A rate period is simply a date range with a price attached. You can set a period to repeat every year automatically (useful for a fixed "summer season" that's always July–August, for example) or set it as a one-off date range for a specific year.

Christmas doesn't trip this up

If your peak period crosses the new year — say, 24th December to 6th January — NestBook handles that correctly as one continuous period, rather than needing you to split it into two separate entries either side of January 1st.

Priority and overlaps

If two rate periods ever overlap on the same date, the one with higher priority wins. This is useful for carving out a short, higher-priced spike (like New Year's Eve itself) inside a longer, lower-priced season, without having to redraw the whole season around it.

Per-room overrides

By default, a rate period applies the same adjustment across every room. If one particular room should be priced differently during that period — your largest suite commanding a bigger premium at Christmas than your smallest room, for instance — you can set a specific override for just that room within the period.

How many rate periods can I have?

Plan	Seasonal rate periods
Free	Not available
Pro	Up to 5
Multi	Unlimited

Where guests see the effect of this

Whenever a guest selects dates — on your widget, your booking page, or when you create a booking manually — NestBook calculates the price night by night, showing exactly which nights fall under which rate. If a stay spans both a normal period and a seasonal period, the booking confirmation and the checkout will clearly break this down (for example: "3 nights × £95, 4 nights × £145 — Summer Peak"), so nobody, including you, has to work it out by hand.

5 Breakfast

Go to [Settings → Breakfast Hours](#) and your room settings

Whole-property owners

If your property is a whole-property rental (a gîte, cottage, or lodge), this step doesn't apply to you — guests self-cater, so breakfast settings are intentionally hidden throughout NestBook for your account. Feel free to skip ahead to Step 6.

If you do offer breakfast, there are three separate layers of control, so you can be as broad or as specific as you like:

Property-wide toggle

In Settings, there's a single toggle to offer breakfast to every guest at your property automatically, on every booking. Only switch this on if that's genuinely your policy — it applies across the board, to every room and every booking, with no exceptions.

Room-level breakfast

If breakfast varies by room type (perhaps only certain rooms include it), you can set this individually on each room in the Rooms section instead of using the property-wide toggle.

Booking-level breakfast

Even with the above two set, you can still add or remove breakfast on an individual booking — useful for a guest who's specifically requested it, or asked not to have it.

Wherever breakfast is included, it shows clearly to the guest — on the booking page, in their confirmation email, and as a distinctive dashed white border on that booking's tile on your Calendar, so you can see at a glance which arriving guests are expecting it.

6 Deposits and getting paid

Go to [Billing](#)

This is one of the sections most owners ask about, so we've written it in full — take your time with it.

Deposit rules

Under Settings, you can decide exactly how you want to handle deposits, entirely on your own terms:

- **Whether to require one at all** — this can be switched off completely if you'd rather not.
- **The type** — a percentage of the total stay, a fixed amount, or the full amount upfront.
- **When the balance is due** — for example, a set number of days before arrival.
- **Your refund policy** — shown to guests so expectations are clear from the start.
- **Automatic emails** — deposit requests, confirmations, and balance-due reminders can all be sent automatically, so you don't have to chase this by hand.

Once switched on, any new booking that needs a deposit will show a clear status (awaiting deposit, deposit received, balance due) both on the booking itself and in the side panel, so you always know where each guest stands financially at a glance.

Accepting real card payments — Stripe Connect ALL PLANS

NestBook lets you accept genuine card payments from guests, with the money going **directly into your own bank account** — not into NestBook's. We never touch your money, and we never take a cut of it. This is available on every plan, including Free.

Setting it up

1. Go to [Billing → Stripe Connect](#) and click "Connect with Stripe."
2. Fill in your business and personal details on Stripe's own secure page — this is Stripe's page, not ours, so your financial details are never seen or stored by NestBook.
3. Stripe will then verify your details. Being honest with you: this isn't instant — it can take anywhere from a few minutes to a day or two, depending on what Stripe needs to check. You'll be brought back here automatically once it's done.

Why the wait, and why it's worth it

Stripe is legally required to verify who's actually receiving guest payments — this is standard practice for any business anywhere in the world accepting card payments, not something specific to NestBook. It only needs doing once.

Once connected, guests can pay you via:

- **Payment links** — send a guest a direct link from any booking, for a deposit or the full balance, by email or however you normally reach them.
- **Your booking widget** PRO MULTI — guests booking through your widget are taken straight to a secure checkout as part of the booking itself.
- **Your standalone booking page** — the same secure checkout, available to anyone who books directly through your NestBook property page.

Fees

NestBook charges nothing for using Stripe Connect. You'll only pay Stripe's own standard card processing fee — the same rate any business anywhere pays to accept card payments. Full details of Stripe's fees are on Stripe's own website.

Disconnecting

You're free to disconnect your Stripe account at any time from the same Billing page. This has no effect on your NestBook subscription — it simply stops new card payments being accepted until you reconnect.

7 Your booking widget and booking page

Go to [Settings → Widget](#)

This is the heart of what NestBook is for: giving your guests a way to book you **directly**, with no commission going to a third party. There are two separate but related tools here.

Your standalone booking page

Every NestBook property automatically gets its own dedicated web page, at an address like:

```
nestbook.io/book/your-property-name
```

This is a real, fast, complete web page — not just a widget — with your photos, room descriptions, live availability, and a map. It's designed to look professional if a guest lands on it directly, and it's also what gets shared correctly (with a proper preview image and description) if you post the link on Facebook or send it by message.

You can edit your page's web address at any time under Settings — just the last part, after `/book/` — so it can be short and easy for you to say out loud or write on a business card.

Embedding the widget on your own website

If you already have your own website, the widget lets you embed live booking availability directly into it, rather than sending visitors away to book elsewhere. Settings will give you a small snippet of code to add to your site — if you're not comfortable editing your own website's code, this is a quick thing to hand to whoever built it, or to ask us about directly.

Sharing your booking page on Facebook

Under Settings → Widget, you'll also find your dedicated booking page link ready to share, along with straightforward instructions for adding a "Book Now" button to your Facebook page that points guests straight to it.

Every plan gets a real booking page

Even on the Free plan, you get your own full standalone booking page — this is never gated behind a paid plan. Widget embedding on your own external website and automatic pay-now checkout during widget bookings are Pro and Multi features.

8 Taking and managing bookings

Go to [Calendar](#) or [Bookings](#)

Adding a booking manually

Click "+ New Booking" from the Dashboard, Calendar, or Bookings screen. The form is built to be quick for repeat guests: start typing a guest's last name and NestBook will search your existing guest records first, so you're not re-typing details for someone who's stayed with you before.

Choose the dates first, and NestBook will show you which rooms are actually available for that exact date range — no need to check the calendar separately beforehand.

The Calendar

A week-by-week visual grid of every room and every booking. Each tile is colour-coded by status, and — if you've set up Seasonal Pricing — a small dot appears on any date with a special rate active, so you can see peak pricing at a glance without opening anything.

The Bookings list

A searchable, filterable table of every booking you've ever taken. Useful for finding a specific guest quickly, or filtering down to just what's arriving this week.

Understanding booking statuses

Status	Meaning
Confirmed	A future booking, not yet arrived
Arriving	Today is the check-in date, but you haven't confirmed arrival yet
In house	The guest has arrived and is currently staying
Checked out	The stay has ended and been confirmed complete
Awaiting approval	A guest has requested to book and is waiting on your Accept/Decline
Cancelled / No show	Self-explanatory — used for your own records and reporting

If you ever forget to check someone in or out

NestBook will notice if a guest's check-in or check-out date has passed without you confirming it, and will show a friendly reminder on your Dashboard asking you to simply confirm what actually happened. Nothing gets stuck or lost if life gets busy.

Extending or shortening a stay

If a guest asks to stay extra nights, open their booking and choose to extend it — NestBook checks the new dates are actually free, works out the correct rate for the extra nights (respecting seasonal pricing if relevant), and gives you a clear breakdown before you confirm. An email is sent to the guest automatically with their new dates and updated total. Shortening a stay works the same way in reverse.

9 Guests and the booking journey

Go to [Guests](#)

Every person who books with you gets a guest record automatically — you never need to create one by hand unless you want to. Over time, this becomes a genuinely useful history: how many times someone has stayed, when they last visited, and their contact details, all in one place.

A typical booking's life, start to finish

1. **Booking made** — by you directly, or by a guest through your widget or booking page.
2. **Confirmation email sent** — automatically, in the guest's own registered language.
3. **Deposit requested** (if you've enabled deposits) — with a reminder as the balance due date approaches.
4. **Check-in day** — the booking status updates to "Arriving," and appears on your Dashboard's arrivals list.
5. **You confirm arrival** — a simple tap moves the booking to "In house."
6. **Stay continues** — you can add charges (Multi plan), breakfast, or handle an extension request at any point.
7. **Check-out day** — you confirm departure, the room becomes available again, and if you use a cleaning workflow, a cleaning flag appears.

If a guest requests to book (rather than you entering it yourself)

When someone books through your widget or page and your settings require your approval, you'll receive an email with a simple Accept or Decline choice — and you can also action this directly inside NestBook from the booking's side panel, without needing to use the email link at all. The guest is automatically emailed the outcome either way.

10 Syncing with Booking.com and Airbnb

Go to [Settings → Calendar Sync](#) — available on every plan

If you also list your property on Booking.com, Airbnb, or similar platforms, the single biggest risk is a **double booking** — someone booking the same room for the same dates on two different platforms, because neither system knew about the other. iCal sync solves this.

How it works

Every room in NestBook has its own unique calendar link. Copy this link and paste it into Booking.com or Airbnb's own calendar-sync settings (both platforms have a section for this — look for "Sync calendars" or "iCal export/import" in their settings). Once connected, any booking made on that platform will automatically block those same dates in NestBook, and vice versa.

NestBook checks for updates from your connected external calendars every 15 minutes, so blocks stay current without you needing to do anything manually. Externally-blocked dates show clearly in grey on your calendar, so you can always tell at a glance whether a blocked date came from a NestBook booking or an external platform.

This is genuinely free, on every plan

Unlike some competitors, calendar sync is never gated behind a paid tier in NestBook — we think protecting you from double bookings shouldn't come with a price tag.

Full step-by-step instructions for connecting Booking.com and Airbnb specifically are also available on our [Help page](#), since their own settings screens occasionally change slightly on their end.

11 Bringing in your existing bookings

Available from the Bookings screen — available on every plan

If you're moving to NestBook from another system and already have upcoming bookings on the books, you don't need to re-type them all in one at a time. The Booking Migration Wizard walks you through importing them from a spreadsheet.

What you'll need

A CSV file (a simple spreadsheet format — Excel, Google Sheets, and most booking systems can all export to CSV) containing your bookings: guest name, email, phone, check-in date, check-out date, room, total price, and any notes. The exact column order doesn't matter — the importer matches by column heading, not position.

The import walks you through:

1. **Uploading your file** — NestBook automatically detects whether it's comma, semicolon, or tab-separated, and handles several different date formats without you needing to reformat anything first.
2. **Matching rooms** — if your old system used different room names, you'll be shown a simple mapping step to match them to your NestBook rooms. (If you're in whole-property mode, this step is skipped entirely, since there's only one property to assign to.)
3. **Reviewing before anything is saved** — you'll see exactly what's about to be imported before it's confirmed, including duplicate-guest detection, so you're not creating a second record for someone already in your Guests list.

Imported bookings show their original total clearly, rather than NestBook trying to guess a nightly rate breakdown for a booking made before you were tracking rates this way.

12 Making NestBook feel like yours

Go to [Settings](#)

Language

NestBook is fully available in English, French, Spanish, German, and Dutch — for you as the owner, and separately for each guest's confirmation emails, which are sent in whatever language they registered or booked in. You can switch your own language instantly, at any time, on every plan.

Staff access PRO MULTI

If you have staff helping run your property, you can invite them with one of three access levels:

Role	Can typically do
Owner / Manager	Full access to everything, including billing and settings
Receptionist	Manage bookings and guests day to day, without access to financial settings
Staff / Charges Staff	More limited access, suited to specific tasks like adding charges during a stay

Features

A simple set of toggles for the features you actually want switched on — the booking widget, email confirmations, breakfast, deposits, and offline mode (letting staff record a booking even without an internet connection, which then syncs once reconnected).

Service Categories MULTI

If you offer extras beyond the room itself — spa treatments, bike hire, an evening meal — Service Categories lets you set these up with their own tax rate, ready to add to a guest's account during their stay via the Charges screen.

13 Reports and keeping records

Go to

Reports

PRO

MULTI

Revenue Reports

A full profit-and-loss view of your property, built from your actual bookings and charges — no manual spreadsheet needed. You can download this as a CSV (to open in Excel or Google Sheets) or as a ready-to-print PDF, whenever you need it for your own records or for an accountant.

Business Expenses

A simple place to log your running costs against the property, so your revenue reports reflect genuine profit, not just income.

Revenue Adjustments

For the occasional manual correction — a refund given outside the normal system, or a one-off adjustment — so your reports stay accurate even for things that didn't happen through a standard booking.

Activity Log

A full audit trail of changes made within your account — useful if you have staff access set up and want a record of who did what, and when. Also available as a CSV export.

14 Getting help whenever you need it

You are never expected to figure everything out alone

The Help Centre

A full searchable reference inside the app, covering every feature in more depth than this guide has room for — including step-by-step instructions for connecting specific platforms like Booking.com and Airbnb. It's available in all five languages.

Reporting a problem

If something isn't working the way you expect, there's a simple error-reporting form at the bottom of your Settings page — just choose a category and describe what happened. This goes straight to our team, and we genuinely read every one.

Contacting us directly

For anything else — a question, a feature you'd like to see, or simply wanting to talk something through — you're always welcome to reach out through the contact form on our website, or by emailing us directly. We're a small, hands-on team, and we'd rather hear from you early than have you struggle in silence.

You're not expected to be technical

NestBook was built for property owners, not developers. If a screen ever feels confusing, that's useful feedback for us, not a reflection on you — please tell us, so we can make it clearer for the next person too.

Quick reference checklist

Print this page, or keep it open, and tick things off as you go. Nothing here is a race.

- ☐ Verify your email (*you've already done this!*)
- ☐ Fill in Property Details — name, type, address, check-in/out times, currency
- ☐ Choose your Appearance theme
- ☐ Add your rooms — or your single whole-property listing — with photos and descriptions
- ☐ Set your base rates
- ☐ Set up any seasonal rate periods that apply to you
- ☐ Decide your breakfast settings, if relevant
- ☐ Decide your deposit policy
- ☐ Connect Stripe if you'd like to accept card payments directly
- ☐ Check your standalone booking page looks right — visit it yourself
- ☐ Set up your widget if you have your own website
- ☐ Connect Booking.com / Airbnb via Calendar Sync, if you list elsewhere
- ☐ Import existing bookings via the Migration Wizard, if needed
- ☐ Invite staff, if you have any, with the right access level
- ☐ Take your first real booking

A few honest reminders

- Everything above can be changed later. Nothing is permanent on first setup.
- You don't have to do this in one sitting. Come back whenever suits you.
- If you get stuck, the Help Centre and our direct contact form are both always available — see Step 14.



Welcome aboard.

We built NestBook because independent properties deserve booking software that actually feels like it was made for them — not a bolted-on afterthought from a giant platform. We're genuinely glad you're here.

— The NestBook Team